High Concept Game Design Document

Use this document to propose a PC game concept for your course project. Replace the Template text with your own content. The Example column demonstrates the expected level of detail.

Student / Team Information

Course	CMPS434
Section	L01
Instructor	Dr. Osama Halabi
Submission Date	22/2/2026

Game Title

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
Working title of your game (short, memorable).	Hollowed Ruins

Team Members

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
List all members with primary responsibility (e.g., Design, Programming, Art, Audio, Production).	1) Majid Marzouq – Lead Designer 2) Oluwadamilola Olajide – Programmer 3) Abdullah Hamed – Sound & Music 4) Mohamad Allouh – 3D Artist & UI

Target Audience (PC)

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template (Students write here)	Example (Reference)
Describe the intended PC audience: age range, experience level, and player motivations.	PC players aged 13–30 who enjoy puzzle solving and strategy. Also, who like tension and dark atmosphere.

Gamer Type

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template (Students write here)	Example (Reference)
Which player types does your game satisfy (e.g., Achiever/Explorer/Socializer/Killer)?	Primarily Explorers, Secondary strategists.

Target Platform (PC Only)

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template (Students write here)	Example (Reference)
Specify PC OS targets (Windows/Linux/macOS) and input (keyboard/mouse, controller).	Windows PC (keyboard/mouse) with optional controller support.

Genre

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template (Students write here)	Example (Reference)
Choose 1–2 genres maximum (e.g., Puzzle, Roguelike, Platformer, Strategy).	Puzzle Adventure + Strategy

Number of Players

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)

Single player or multiplayer (local/online)? If multiplayer, how many players?	Single Player

Projected Release Date

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
Target milestone for course submission (alpha/beta/final).	Final build: Week 13 (Fall 2026)

Concept Details (L1–L7)

These sections explain the concept at a pitch level. Do not write a full GDD here.

L1: High Concept Statement

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
One paragraph pitch: who the player is, what they do, and why it is fun. Include the core loop in one sentence.	A single-player puzzle adventure game where the player explores a haunted ruin while being hunted by a ghost trying to take over their body. When caught, the game shifts into a strategic chess challenge to escape possession.

L2: Feature Set

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
Bullet list of 5–8 core features/mechanics. Focus on what will be in the prototype.	• Third Person • Puzzle Solving • Ghost AI and Maze Solving • Strategic Chess • Health System • Haunted Atmosphere

L3: Team Roles

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
Describe responsibilities and deliverables per role. Make sure every feature has an owner.	Design: Core loop, puzzle design, balancing ghost encounters Programming: Movement, ghost AI, chess system, health system Art: Ruin environment, ghost design, chess board UI, menus Audio: Ambient sounds, ghost effects, tension music

L4: The Competition

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
List 2–3 comparable PC games. Explain similarities and your differentiation in 3–5 sentences.	Comparable to **The Ouroboros King** and **Phantom Abyss**. Like *The Ouroboros King*, our game blends strategic depth with roguelike progression. Like *Phantom Abyss*, it uses procedurally generated runs to enhance replayability. Our differentiation is merging tactical board-based combat with real-time dungeon action in one cohesive experience.

L5: Innovation / Creativity

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
What is new or meaningfully remixed? Explain the “twist” and why it improves the player experience.	Combines real-time chase gameplay with turn-based strategic survival.

	The chess match is not full-length; it is a goal-based mini challenge, making it faster and more intense. The ghost does not just kill the player it slowly possesses them over time, increasing tension.

L6: Design Goals

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
3–6 goals stated as outcomes (player should feel/learn/experience). Include accessibility or usability goals if possible.	Players feel constant tension while exploring Chess challenges feel intense but fair Losing feels punishing but not frustrating Clear UI and readable objective Strong atmosphere through sound and lighting

L7: Scope Management

Keep it concise and specific. Bullet points are encouraged where appropriate.

Template	Example (Reference)
Define in-scope (MVP) vs stretch goals vs out-of-scope. Keep MVP doable within the course timeline.	MVP: One level, one ghost AI, chess mini-challenge (3 objectives), spirit health system, basic UI and audio. Stretch Goals: More levels, varied ghost behavior, additional chess challenges, simple story scenes. Out of Scope: Multiplayer, open world, full chess engine, RPG systems.

Submission Checklist

☐ All sections completed (no blanks).

☐ High concept statement includes player fantasy + core loop.

☐ Feature set matches team capacity and timeline.

☐ Competition includes at least two PC titles.

☐ Scope clearly states MVP and what is excluded.